

ONSET OF ACTION · eCTM vs. STANDARD OF CARE · BERTONE ET AL. 2026

How fast does it work? Separation begins by week 2.

eCTM outperformed standard of care on pain and swelling by 2 weeks, lameness by 4 weeks.

By outcome, by week When each clinical outcome separated from standard of care.

PAIN · FIRST SEPARATION

2 wk

eCTM vs. standard of care ·
p<0.05

Pain scores diverged at the first follow-up window. By week 2, eCTM horses were already scoring lower than standard-of-care controls.

SWELLING · FIRST SEPARATION

2 wk

eCTM vs. standard of care ·
p<0.05

Joint effusion / soft-tissue swelling separated by the 2-week mark in the eCTM arm and stayed lower through week 12.

LAMENESS · FIRST SEPARATION

4 wk

eCTM vs. standard of care ·
p<0.05

AAEP lameness grade separated by week 4 and widened through week 12, with sustained superiority to week 26.

Recovery timeline

Week 2

1

Pain + swelling separate.

Week 4

2

Lameness separates.

Week 12

3

All three outcomes hold their lead.

Week 26

4

Return-to-work signal preserved.

What this means at the clinic

Set expectations at 2 weeks, not 6.

The paper's earliest scored follow-up was week 2 — and pain and swelling had already separated. Tell owners the treated horse should look and feel different at the first re-check, not a month in.

Follow-up at 2 / 4 / 12 / 26 matches the paper.

The trial's follow-up windows are a defensible template for any first case. It also aligns the vet-owner conversation to the same numbers the paper reports.

Book the lameness re-eval at week 4.

Structural lameness improvement showed up at week 4. That is the right cadence for the first substantive clinical decision: is this horse responding, or is it time to escalate?

Single injection — no re-dose gate at 4 wk.

Onset was achieved with one injection. If the horse is trending in the right direction at week 2 or 4, that is the trial's expected trajectory — not a signal to re-inject.

Separation by week 2. Superiority by week 4. Held to 26 weeks.

A single eCTM injection out-paced clinician-selected standard of care from the first scored follow-up onward.

Equine Performance Labs